

Bug Report: “Go Back to Previous Page” Button Redirects to Main Homepage Instead of Previous Workflow Step

1. Bug Title

The “Go Back to Previous Page” button incorrectly redirects users to the main homepage instead of returning them to the immediately previous workflow page.

2. Button Affected

The affected button is the newly added or intended universal workflow navigation button:

“← Previous Page” / “Go Back to Previous Page”

This is separate from the existing:

“← Back to Main Workspace”

button.

The existing “Back to Main Workspace” button is expected to return users directly to the main workspace and should remain unchanged.

3. Expected Behavior

When a user clicks “Go Back to Previous Page,” the system should return the user to the immediately preceding page or module in the workflow sequence.

Examples:

Deadline Details → Previous Page → Case / Matter Details

Case / Matter Details → Previous Page → Client Details

Document Details → Previous Page → Deadline Details

Review / Save & Submit → Previous Page → Document Details

The button should behave like workflow-step navigation, not like a homepage shortcut.

4. Actual Behavior

When the user clicks “Go Back to Previous Page,” the app redirects to the main homepage / main workspace regardless of which workflow page the user is currently on.

This causes users to lose their workflow position and forces them to manually re-enter the page or module they were previously using.

5. Pages / Modules Affected

The issue affects intermediate workflow pages, including:

- Client Details
- Case / Matter Details
- Matter Details
- Deadline Details
- Court Dates
- Document Details
- Review / Save & Submit
- Matter Intake
- Any other module opened through the workspace flow

6. Steps to Reproduce

1. Open the Litigation 360 application.
2. Start from the main End User Workspace.
3. Click “Client Details.”
4. Click “Save & Next → Case / Matter Details.”
5. From Case / Matter Details, click “Save & Next → Deadline Details.”
6. Click “Go Back to Previous Page.”
7. Observe that the system returns to the main homepage / workspace instead of returning to Case / Matter Details.

Alternative reproduction path:

1. Main Workspace → Client Details
2. Client Details → Case / Matter Details
3. Case / Matter Details → Deadline Details
4. Deadline Details → Document Details
5. Click “Go Back to Previous Page”
6. Actual result: returns to homepage
7. Expected result: returns to Deadline Details

7. Environment Scope

This issue is likely browser-independent because the application uses React internal state navigation rather than true browser route navigation.

Likely affected environments:

Chrome
Edge
Firefox
Desktop browser
Potentially all devices running the same frontend build

This should still be confirmed by testing across browsers.

8. Probable Technical Cause

The application appears to use React state-based navigation, such as:

```
module  
setModule
```

Instead of URL-based navigation or React Router history.

The “Previous Page” logic is likely falling back to:

```
setModule("home")
```

or equivalent homepage navigation because no workflow history stack is being recorded.

In other words, the app knows the current module but does not remember which module the user came from.

Because of that, the Previous Page button has no valid previous workflow step to return to and defaults to the homepage.

9. Technical Root Cause

The navigation system does not currently maintain a previous-module history.

The forward buttons likely call direct navigation such as:

```
setModule("Cases")  
setModule("Court Dates")
```

```
setModule("Documents")  
setModule("Review Submit")
```

Direct calls to setModule change the current page but do not record the previous page.

As a result, back-navigation cannot determine whether the user came from Clients, Cases, Court Dates, Documents, or another module.

10. Recommended Fix

Create a central workflow navigation function that records the current module before moving to the next module.

Recommended approach:

1. Add a module history state array.
2. Replace direct workflow navigation with a controlled goToModule function.
3. Push the current module into history before navigating forward.
4. Make the Previous Page button pop the last module from history.
5. Keep "Back to Main Workspace" as a separate function that clears history and returns to home.
6. Do not modify the existing forward button labels or main workspace button behavior.

11. Fix Logic

The correct behavior should be:

When user clicks a forward/module button:

Save current module into history
Move to next module

When user clicks Previous Page:

If history exists, return to the last module
If no history exists, safely return to main workspace

When user clicks Back to Main Workspace:

Clear history
Return to home

12. Regression Testing Required

Test the following paths:

Main Workspace → Clients → Previous Page
Expected: Main Workspace

Main Workspace → Clients → Save & Next → Cases → Previous Page
Expected: Clients

Clients → Cases → Court Dates → Previous Page
Expected: Cases

Cases → Court Dates → Documents → Previous Page
Expected: Court Dates

Documents → Review / Save & Submit → Previous Page
Expected: Documents

Any module → Back to Main Workspace
Expected: Main Workspace

Refresh inside a module → Previous Page
Expected: Safe fallback to Main Workspace, not a blank page or error

13. Priority

Priority: Medium to High

Reason:

This bug affects workflow usability and causes unnecessary navigation steps. It does not appear to corrupt data, but it creates poor user experience and can interrupt multi-step legal workflow entry.

14. Risk Classification

Risk classification: Medium

Reason:

The change affects frontend workflow navigation and user experience, but should not require backend, database, authentication, or RBAC changes if implemented properly.

15. Acceptance Criteria

The fix is accepted when:

The Previous Page button returns to the immediately previous workflow step.
The Back to Main Workspace button still returns directly to the workspace.

The Save & Next button still moves forward correctly.
No existing module is broken.
No backend or database changes are introduced.
The app compiles successfully in Vite.
The white screen / parse error does not return.